

How we get **free, unlimited** meeting transcripts — without buying a single tool

Every transcript tool hits a paywall. We built a pipeline using Fathom, Zapier, Google Drive, and Claude AI — delivering full transcripts and conversational meeting intelligence, completely free.

\$0

Monthly cost

∞

Meetings supported

4

Steps to set up

0

Manual site visits

THE PROBLEM

Transcripts are expensive — or limited

Meeting transcripts have become essential for distributed teams. But the moment you start scaling, the free tiers of every major tool disappear behind a paywall. **Is there a way to get full, unlimited transcripts without yet another subscription?**

■ The real friction points

- Free tools cap you at 300–800 min/month — one heavy week and you're locked out.
- Paid tools charge per user, per seat, or per minute — costs compound fast.
- Transcripts sit siloed in third-party dashboards with no easy way to query them.
- No tool lets you have a conversation with your meeting data out of the box.

EXPLORATION

What we tried first

We evaluated the major transcript tools: what's genuinely free, and what you actually got before hitting a wall.

Free tools **Limited**

- Otter.ai — 800 min/month cap
- Fireflies — 800 min/month free tier
- Fathom — free, data stays on their site
- Rev — per-minute charges after trial

Paid tools **Expensive**

- Notion AI — extra add-on cost
- Zoom AI Companion — paid plan required
- Teams Premium — per-user licensing
- All charge the moment you scale up

Fathom stood out — genuinely free, no minute limits. The only catch: **your data lives on Fathom's site** and you must visit manually. That gave us the idea for the pipeline.

THE SOLUTION

A 4-step automation pipeline

We connected Fathom, Google Meet, Zapier, Google Drive, and Claude AI into a seamless pipeline.



STEP 1 · FATHOM

Integrate Fathom with Google Meet

Connect Google Meet to Fathom. Every meeting is recorded and transcribed automatically — free, no minute cap.



STEP 2 · ZAPIER

Automate: Fathom recording → Google Drive

A Zap fires after each meeting, saving the transcript directly to a designated Google Drive folder.



ISSUE IDENTIFIED

Only a link saves — not the transcript

Zapier's Fathom integration saves a link only, not transcript text. Workaround: use Claude's native Fathom connector.



STEP 3 · CLAUDE AI

Enable Fathom connector inside Claude

Claude's native Fathom connector reads transcript content directly from the API, bypassing the link-only limitation.



STEP 4 · RESULT

Interact with meeting data — unlimited & free

Ask Claude anything about any meeting. Summarize, extract action items, compare calls — conversationally, free.

THE KEY INSIGHT

Claude bridges the data gap

Fathom does the hard work of transcribing. But the intelligence — the ability to search, query, and extract meaning from meetings — needs one more layer.

⊗ Without Claude

- Only a Fathom link saved to Drive — not the content
- Manual Fathom visit required every time
- No cross-meeting search or querying
- Data locked in a third-party UI



✓ With Claude + Fathom connector

- Claude fetches full transcript on demand
- Ask anything in plain language — no site visit
- Summarise, extract action items, search meetings
- Unlimited — Claude has no meeting cap

WHAT WE LEARNED

Key takeaways

✓ Lessons from building this pipeline

- 1 Free tools can be powerful if you design the data flow yourself — the limitation is usually access, not quality.
- 2 Zapier is the connective tissue. Without it, every step is manual. With it, the pipeline runs invisibly.
- 3 The real unlock isn't transcription — it's conversational access to your meeting data. Claude makes this possible without custom engineering.
- 4 MCP connectors like Fathom's in Claude are underrated. They turn Claude from a chat tool into an active data retrieval layer.
- 5 This approach scales linearly — 10 meetings or 1,000 meetings, the cost stays \$0.

TOOLS USED

The full stack

Every tool in this pipeline is either free or something your team likely already uses.

■ Google Meet	■ Fathom (free plan)	■ Zapier (free tier)
■ Google Drive	■ Claude AI	■ Fathom MCP Connector